

The FreeBSD operating system is an open-source and free Unix-like operating system derived from the ‘Research Unix-based’ Berkeley Software Distribution (BSD). Having released its first version in 1993, FreeBSD went on to amass many users in the subsequent years. In 2005, it became the most popular open-source BSD operating system and added up to more than three-quarters of all installed BSD-style licensed systems. Although FreeBSD draws a large number of similarities and parallels with Linux, the two differ from each other primarily on the grounds of licensing and in scope. While FreeBSD maintains a complete system where the project implements device drivers, documentation, kernel, and userland utilities, Linux is majorly concerned with delivering just the drivers and the kernel and mostly relies on third-parties for system software. Additionally, the FreeBSD source code is usually and typically released under a permissive BSD license, when on the contrary, Linux uses the copyleft GPL.

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FreeBSD is an open-source operating system

The FreeBSD project includes a security team that maintains supervision of the overall software shipped during base distribution. Further, it presents users with the scope of installing a broad and diverse range of third-party applications using

the pkg package management system or utilising FreeBSD ports. Alternatively, this can also be achieved by compiling source code. Since its release, a large part of FreeBSD’s codebase has established itself as an integral part of other operating systems such as TrueNAS, Darwin, and the system software for PlayStation 3 and PlayStation 4 game consoles.

Virtual consoles and terminals

If the FreeBSD operating system hasn’t been configured to launch a graphical environment at the time of startup automatically, then the system will always boot into a command-line login prompt. The first line seen in the prompt is invariably indicative of some information revolving around the system. If it happens to display ‘amd64’, that means the system in question is running a version of FreeBSD that is 64-bit. Other information enclosed in the first line represents the hostname and whether the console invoked is